WILLIAMSTOWN | ADVANCE SCOUTING

Prepared for Melbourne Baseball Club | Saturday 24 October 2026 | Three supplied games

Evaluation key: Red = priority hitter / strong pitcher. Green = weak hitter / weak pitcher. Amber = monitor / average pitcher. These are early box-score classifications, not video scouting grades.

BATTING | THREE SUPPLIED GAMES

BATTER	BATS	AB	H	BB	RBI	HR	AVG	OBP	READ
Hiroshi Narasaki	·	7	4	2	2	0	.571	.600	PRIORITY
Joh Nakazawa	·	7	3	5	3	0	.429	.667	PRIORITY
Mitchell Collins	·	7	3	1	0	0	.429	.500	MONITOR
Harper Rickard	RHH	12	5	0	5	0	.417	.417	PRIORITY
Daniel Hamilton	·	7	2	2	0	0	.286	.444	MONITOR
Mitchell Zahariades	·	9	2	3	2	0	.222	.417	MONITOR
Rudy Haruta	·	5	1	0	1	0	.200	.200	MONITOR - SMALL SAMPLE SIZE (5 OR FEWER AB)
Samuel Reale	·	13	2	1	4	1	.154	.214	MONITOR
Dennis Neal	RHH	7	1	1	1	0	.143	.250	WEAK
Jai Diblasi	·	7	1	0	1	0	.143	.143	WEAK
Daniel Chircop	·	8	1	3	1	0	.125	.364	WEAK
Austin Caulfield	·	2	0	1	0	0	.000	.333	MONITOR - SMALL SAMPLE SIZE (5 OR FEWER AB)
Jason Mcdonald	·	1	0	0	0	0	.000	.000	MONITOR - SMALL SAMPLE SIZE (5 OR FEWER AB)
Lucas Joel	·	1	0	0	0	0	.000	.000	MONITOR - SMALL SAMPLE SIZE (5 OR FEWER AB)

Samuel Reale — MONITOR (power): .154 AVG (2-for-13), but 1 HR and 4 RBI. Do not treat his low average as evidence of limited damage potential.

OBP: (Hits + walks + hit-by-pitch) / (at-bats + walks + hit-by-pitch + sacrifice flies). Calculated from supplied game lines.

PITCHING | THREE SUPPLIED GAMES

PITCHER	THROWS	IP	H	BB	SO	ER	ERA	WHIP	READ
Samuel Reale	·	1.1	0	0	2	0	0.00	0.00	STRONG
Mitchell Zahariades	·	11.0	12	7	6	4	3.27	1.73	STRONG
Dennis Neal	LHP	5.0	11	3	3	5	9.00	2.80	WEAK*
Daniel Chircop	·	1.1	3	0	0	2	13.50	2.25	WEAK
Daniel Hamilton	·	5.1	7	3	6	8	13.50	1.88	WEAK

* Dennis Neal: prior professional experience (Melbourne Aces, ABL); left-handed pitcher (LHP).
Current-season WEAK classification is retained; use extra caution given his higher-level background.

Pitching thresholds: Strong = ERA 4.00 or lower; Average = above 4.00 through 5.00; Weak = above 5.00. No pitcher in this sample falls into the average range.

WHIP: (Hits allowed + walks allowed) / innings pitched. Baseball innings notation is used: 1.1 means one inning and one out, not 1.1 decimal innings.

COACHING NOTES

On the mound: Prioritize Rickard, Narasaki and Nakazawa based on early hit/on-base production. Reale belongs on the monitor list despite his .154 average because of his home run and four RBIs. Attack lower-average hitters with strikes; specific pitch-location tendencies cannot be inferred from box scores.

At the plate: Zahariades (3.27 ERA, 1.73 WHIP over 11.0 IP) has the strongest established ERA in the supplied workload. Reale has a 0.00 ERA but only 1.1 IP. Hamilton, Neal and Chircop have ERAs above 5.00; look for opportunities without assuming Saturday availability.

Data note: Three supplied game-level records; classifications are subject to small samples. No pitch tracking, video, handedness or confirmed lineup was provided. Prepared as a coaching reference, not an official league publication.

PREGAME STRATEGY NOTES

Saturday 24 October 2026 • Based on three supplied game box scores

OFFENSIVE APPROACH | MELBOURNE AT THE PLATE

Mitchell Zahariades — make him work. Across 11.0 innings, Zahariades has allowed **7 walks and 12 hits** (1.73 WHIP), despite a strong **3.27 ERA**. Look to see pitches early, stay selective outside the strike zone and avoid helping him with chase swings. If he is struggling to find the zone, make him prove he can throw strikes. This is a disciplined approach, not an instruction to take hittable strikes.

Get to the next arm. Zahariades has the largest recorded workload in this sample. Lengthening plate appearances may create an opportunity to see Williamstown's other pitchers. **Dennis Neal (9.00 ERA, 2.80 WHIP)** and **Daniel Hamilton (13.50 ERA, 1.88 WHIP)** have allowed more runs to date; be ready to attack strikes rather than assuming either will appear.

Do not underestimate Samuel Reale. His pitching line is excellent (0.00 ERA, 0.00 WHIP), but it covers only **1.1 innings**. Treat him as a limited-sample arm, not a confirmed shutdown option.

DEFENSIVE APPROACH | MELBOURNE ON THE MOUND

Keep traffic off for the productive hitters. Harper Rickard (.417 AVG, 5 RBI), Hiroshi Narasaki (.571 AVG), and Joh Nakazawa (.667 OBP) have been the most notable threats by the supplied numbers. Prioritize quality strikes and avoid free baserunners ahead of them.

Reale is a power exception. Samuel Reale is batting .154, but has **1 HR and 4 RBI**. Keep him in the monitor group and avoid treating his batting average as an automatic green light in RBI situations.

Challenge low-average hitters without giving away walks. Daniel Chircop (.125 AVG), Jai Diblasi (.143), Dennis Neal (.143) and Rudy Haruta (.200) are early statistical attack candidates. Work ahead with competitive strikes; do not infer specific swing holes or pitch-type weaknesses from box scores alone.

PREGAME CHECKS

Confirm Williamstown's starting pitcher and batting order; check whether Zahariades is available after his prior workload; review any game video or pitch-by-pitch records for first-pitch strike rate, count leverage, chase tendencies and defensive positioning.

Evidence limit: Seven walks support a patient approach against Zahariades, but the supplied box scores do **not** show how often he fell behind in counts. These recommendations are preliminary and should be updated with pitch-level data when available.

ADDITIONAL OFFENSIVE PLAN | RUNNING GAME & SMALL BALL

Alongside working the count, consider testing the running game early and using situational small ball - particularly if Mitchell Zahariades starts. During the first trip through the lineup, each batter could consider taking pitches until the first strike to help build the starter's pitch count, while staying ready to attack a clear hittable strike when the situation calls for it. A successful steal, well-placed bunt or hit-and-run can pressure the defense, create scoring chances and force more decisions from the pitcher. Combined with patient at-bats, this may shorten the starter's outing. Be selective: run when the pitcher/catcher matchup, lead and game situation support it; avoid unnecessary outs. The supplied box scores do not establish Zahariades' time to the plate, pickoff tendencies or Williamstown's caught-stealing rates - verify those before setting an aggressive steal plan.

HIGHER-LEVEL EXPERIENCE CHECK

Supplement to 24 October 2026 scouting report | Public-record research

CONFIRMED AUSTRALIAN BASEBALL LEAGUE EXPERIENCE

HARPER RICKARD — ABL / Melbourne Aces (2023–24)
Baseball-Reference records two ABL games and one at-bat with the Aces. This is a confirmed higher-level appearance, not evidence of sustained ABL offensive success. He remains a priority based on his current Williamstown production. Also selected for Victoria U18 in 2023.

DENNIS NEAL — ABL / Melbourne Aces (2024 season)
Recorded five innings, six strikeouts and a 1.80 ERA in two ABL appearances. A separate 2020 ABL record lists a one-inning appearance with Canberra. Baseball Victoria also reported a 12-strikeout complete-game performance for Williamstown in 2020–21. **Scouting adjustment:** retain the current-season WEAK ERA category, but add an experience caution: do not assume he lacks the ability to miss bats.

OTHER VERIFIED PLAYING BACKGROUND

SAMUEL REALE — NCAA Division III / Iowa Wesleyan
Baseball Victoria confirms that Reale received a scholarship and joined Iowa Wesleyan University's NCAA Division III baseball team; it also cites a 2017 Don Deeble Rising Star Award. This is U.S. collegiate experience, **not NCAA Division I**, and no collegiate performance totals were verified here. Keep the existing MONITOR / POWER note (1 HR, 4 RBI).

HARPER RICKARD — State representative experience
Baseball Victoria named Rickard to the 2023 Victorian U18 state team and to the 2024 Victoria All Stars exhibition roster against the Melbourne Aces. The All Stars appearance should not be counted as professional ABL service.

IDENTITY / EVIDENCE LIMITS

A Baseball-Reference profile for a **Mitchell Collins** shows successful NCAA Division I seasons at North Florida (.307 in 2025 and .311 in 2026). However, Williamstown's Mitchell Collins is documented playing for the club in 2019–20, and available records do not establish that these are the same person. **Do not attribute that college career to Williamstown's player without confirmation.** No other listed players were positively verified as NCAA Division I or professional players from the sources reviewed.

SOURCE REFERENCES

ABL: 2023–24 Melbourne Aces batting

ABL: 2024 pitching leaders (Dennis Neal)

Baseball Victoria: 2020–21 Round 11

Baseball Victoria: college-bound Samuel Reale

Baseball Victoria: 2023 U18 state team

Baseball Victoria: 2024 Victoria All Stars